

ERIC GUAN PHOTOGRAPHY

Real Estate Photography 12-Month Launch Plan

A practical year roadmap: lens, outreach, systems, pricing, and growth
— built for your Sony a6400.

Camera: Sony a6400 Focus: Listing photography Year 1

The year in four phases

PHASE 1

M0–1

Setup + outreach

Buy lens, shoot practice homes, contact known agents.

PHASE 2

M2–3

Systems + quality

Booking flow, checklists, first upsells, raise prices.

PHASE 3

M4–9

Repeat clients

Become the reliable shooter. Productize packages.

PHASE 4

M10–12

Stabilize

Referrals, rate review, year-2 gear decisions.

Rule for Year 1: Photos first. Video is an optional upsell. No drone, no second body, no fancy kit until demand pays for it.

Buy this wide-angle lens

PRIMARY RECOMMENDATION

Sigma 10–18mm f/2.8 DC DN

Sony E-mount · APS-C · Contemporary

- 10mm $\approx$ 15mm full-frame — best for tight rooms
- Light and easy for all-day listing shoots
- Shoot interiors around f/7.1–f/9
- Budget: ~\$600–650 new · ~\$450–550 used

RUNNER-UP

Tamron 11–20mm f/2.8

Slightly less wide, more reach + weather sealing.

DO NOT BUY YET

- Gimbal
- Drone
- Second camera body
- Complex lighting kits

High-ROI kit (cheap)

01

Tripod

Sturdy travel tripod · \$80–150. Locked shots beat shaky walkthroughs.

02

Batteries + cards

2–3 spare batteries · 128GB+ fast SD cards.

03

CPL filter

67mm polarizer for exterior glass and sky control.

04

Editing

Lightroom or Capture One. Free start: Darktable / LR trial.

05

Month 2–3

Optional: Godox flash (V1 / V860III Sony) for dark rooms + twilight.

PRIORITY

Lens > lights > video gear

Get the Sigma first. Everything else waits for paid demand.

Setup before you message anyone

CAMERA PRESETS

- RAW always
- f/7.1–f/9
- ISO 100–400
- WB Auto or Kelvin ~4000–5000
- Bracket ± 1 or ± 2 EV for bright windows
- Use grid — keep verticals straight

PRACTICE GOAL

Shoot 3 homes free

Your place, family/friend home, or open house with permission.

- Edit bright, clean, true color
- Straight verticals on every frame
- Deliver 15–30 images per home
- Replace all stock photos on your site

Standard shot list

01–02

Exterior front · straight-on + 45°

03–04

Entry · Living room

05–06

Kitchen overall · island/detail

07–08

Dining · Primary bedroom

09–10

Primary bath · Secondary rooms

11–12

Laundry/garage · Backyard/patio

Later: Twilight exterior only when you can stay for blue hour. Don't block Month 0 on it.

Portfolio + business setup

MUST SHIP

- Website live with **your** photos only
- Free host: GitHub Pages
- Simple pricing page / PDF
- Invoice: Wave (free) or Stripe
- Phone you actually answer
- Payment: e-transfer / Venmo / Zelle / Stripe

PROMISE TO AGENTS

24–48 hrs

Edited photos delivered ready for MLS and marketing. Reliability beats fancy gear.

Intro pricing (adjust to your city)

PACKAGE	INCLUDES	PRICE
Essentials	15–25 edited stills	\$150–250
Standard	25–40 stills, full coverage	\$225–350
Premium	Stills + twilight or short Reel	\$350–500

Underprice slightly at first for **reviews + referrals**. Raise rates every 5–10 completed jobs.

Contact agents you already know

BEFORE YOU TEXT

- ❑ 8–12 strong portfolio images
- ❑ Website live with your work
- ❑ 24–48h turnaround promise
- ❑ One discounted first-listing offer

BUILD A LIST OF 10–20

- Agents you've met
- Friends/family agents
- Open-house / showing contacts
- Friends who can intro an agent

Week 1 target: message 10–20 people. Follow up once after 5–7 days. Then stop nudging.

Message scripts

FIRST TOUCH

Hey [Name] — I'm starting real estate photography locally. Portfolio: [link]. I'm opening a few discounted first-listing spots this month for agents I already know. If you have a listing coming up, I'd love to shoot it — 24–48hr turnaround.

IF THEY SAY YES

For a typical [2–3 bed / condo], intro rate is \$[X] for [Y] edited photos in 48 hours. Want me to hold a slot for your next listing?

ONE FOLLOW-UP ONLY

Hey [Name], just bumping this in case it got buried. Happy to shoot one listing at \$[discount] so you can see the workflow.

10-minute call agenda

- Show 6 best photos on your phone
- Explain: book → shoot 45–90 min → deliver 24–48h
- Ask what they hate about current photographers
- Ask when their next listing is
- Offer one discounted shoot + review after

DISCOUNT RULES

- One discounted property per agent max
- Call it an “intro rate” in writing
- Get permission to use photos
- Ask for a referral after delivery

Booking flow (use every time)

1

Request

Address, date, package

2

Confirm

Time, access, staging, pets, parking,
price

3

Shoot

45–90 minutes on site

4

Deliver

Drive/Dropbox + invoice + review ask

CONFIRM TEMPLATE

Confirmed for [Address] on [Day] at [Time]. Package: [Standard] — \$[price]. Please have lights on, blinds open, counters clear, cars out of driveway if possible. Edited photos within 48 hours.

Shoot-day checklist

- ☐ Arrive 5–10 min early
- ☐ Walk the property once
- ☐ Lights on, TV off, fans off
- ☐ Hide trash, cords, remotes, magnets
- ☐ Exterior first if light is good
- ☐ Verticals straight every frame
- ☐ Consistent camera height

MONTH 2 WEEKLY GOALS

- 2–4 paid or discounted shoots
- 5 new agent outreaches / week
- Collect 3 written testimonials

Raise quality — keep video light

DO THIS

- Add flash for dark rooms / twilight practice
- Learn simple window pull / HDR blend
- Raise prices ~10–20% after 8–10 jobs
- Ask every happy agent for team intros
- Attend 1 local realtor networking event

VIDEO WITHOUT A GIMBAL

- 5–8 locked tripod clips
- 20–40s vertical Reel
- Stabilize in CapCut if needed
- Charge +\$50–100 at first
- Only after photos are solid

Mid-year targets

METRIC	TARGET BY MONTH 6
Paid shoots	20-40 total
Repeat agents	3-5
Average order value	\$250-400
Turnaround	≤ 48 hours, every time
Portfolio properties	12+ real listings

Buy flash / better tripod only if earning. Buy a used gimbal only if agents ask for walkthroughs weekly. No drone yet.

Turn work into a product

LOOK

Edit preset

Lock your bright/clean style so delivery stays fast.

UPSELL

Twilight

Fixed add-on +\$75-150.

UPSELL

Reel

Fixed add-on +\$75-150.

PARTNERS

Don't buy everything

Refer drone / staging / cleaning partners.

DISTRIBUTION

Leave-behind PDF

Samples + packages + contact for brokerages.

PITCH

30 seconds

Clean listing photos fast. 24-48h.
Standard at \$[X]. Backup or primary for your team.

End-of-year goals

- 4-8 shoots per month (more if going full-time)
- 50%+ work from repeats / referrals
- Market pricing – not intro pricing
- Site shows only your real listings
- Emergency kit: batteries, cards, cloths, rain cover

DECIDE WITH DATA

- Agents ask for video often → used gimbal
- Luxury work appears → twilight mastery
- Calendar mostly full → raise 15-25%
- Slow months → reactivate past agents

Admin: track mileage + gear · separate business account when regular · save ~25-30% for taxes · simple service agreement.

Month-by-month map

0 Buy Sigma 10-18 · 3 practice homes · fix portfolio	1 Message known agents · book discounted first jobs	2 Systems: booking, checklist, delivery, invoices
3 Flash + edits · soft video upsell · slight price raise	4-5 Repeat clients · testimonials · track every job	6 Reliability reputation · mid-year price review
7-8 Twilight + Reel upsells · brokerage intros	9 Partner referrals · leave-behind PDF	10-12 Speed presets · fill calendar · year-2 decisions

Do these 7 things this week

- ☐ Order Sigma 10–18mm f/2.8 (Sony E)
- ☐ Order tripod + 2 batteries
- ☐ Shoot one practice home this weekend
- ☐ Put your real photos on the site

- ☐ Write agent list (names + phone)
- ☐ Send first-touch text to 5 agents
- ☐ Set intro price + 48-hour promise

NEXT STEP

**Buy the lens.
Shoot one home.
Text five agents.**

Photos first. Reliability second. Video later.

Eric Guan Photography Real Estate · Year 1